

Yu Sun, M.Sc.

User Experience Researcher | Mixed-Methods Researcher | Human-Computer Interaction | AI & VR/MR
Brauerstrasse 21, St. Gallen 9000, Switzerland | yu.sun@unisg.ch | +41 763762019 | [LinkedIn](#)

UX Researcher with over five years of experience conducting end-to-end mixed-methods research across academia and industry. Experienced in translating user insights into product strategy through mixed-method research, usability testing, surveys, field studies, diary studies, and co-design. Passionate about improving digital products by combining rigorous research with AI-powered workflows and close collaboration with product, design, and engineering teams.

Links

[Google Scholar](#)

Education

University of St. Gallen

Ph.D. in HCI, Feb 2023 to Jul 2026

Research focus: Human-Computer Interaction | Virtual & Mixed Reality | Conversational & Physical AI | Social Robotics | User Experience Design | Human-Centred Computing | More-than-human Design | Digital Innovation

LMU Munich

M.Sc. in HCI, Oct 2019 to Jul 2022

User-Centred Design | Intelligent User Interfaces | Web & Android Development | Augmented & Virtual Reality | Accessibility | Physical Computing

Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications

B.Sc. in Digital Media Technology, Sept 2014 to Jun 2018

Programming | Algorithms & Data Structures | Software Engineering | Digital Media Technology

Experiences

Doctoral Researcher, University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen, Switzerland

Feb 2023 to Aug 2026

- Designed and conducted qualitative and mixed-methods research investigating the use of AI, virtual reality, and interactive technologies in everyday life.
- Planned and facilitated interviews, co-design workshops, focus groups, and usability studies with diverse participant groups.
- Collaborated with public organisations, industry partners, and multidisciplinary teams to translate research findings into practical applications.
- Developed reports, scientific publications, presentations, and recommendations for academic and non-academic stakeholders.
- Mentored Bachelor's and Master's students in research design, interview techniques, user-centred design, qualitative analysis, scientific writing, and project management.

Teaching Assistant, University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen, Switzerland

- Delivered tutorials, workshops, and hands-on laboratory sessions in Algorithms & Data Structures, Human-Computer Interaction, Human-Centred Design, and Hands-on HCI.
- Mentored interdisciplinary student teams throughout the entire innovation process—from problem identification and research design to prototyping, implementation, evaluation, and scientific communication.
- Encouraged and supported students in extending course projects beyond the classroom into research publications, conference demonstrations, entrepreneurial initiatives, and real-world applications.

HCI & UX Researcher, fortiss GmbH, Munich, Germany

Jul 2022 to Oct 2022

- Conducted user-centred research to inform the design of AI-powered digital products and Human-AI interaction.
- Facilitated stakeholder interviews and journey-mapping workshops to identify user needs and innovation opportunities for enterprise software.
- Developed research frameworks and design recommendations that translated academic evidence into product and AI strategy.

Unity Developer & Interaction Designer, BMW Group, Munich, Germany

Feb 2022 to Jul 2022

- Designed and prototyped interactive in-car experiences using Unity and rapid prototyping tools to explore future mobility concepts.
- Developed multiplayer virtual environments for collecting user behaviour data to support AI model development.
- Conducted design research on game mechanics and interaction concepts for next-generation voice assistants.
- Collaborated within interdisciplinary teams to transform user-centred design concepts into functional prototypes.

Software Engineering Trainee, Zühlke GmbH, Munich, Germany

Jul 2021 to Nov 2021

- Contributed to the development of IoT solutions for smart construction, integrating embedded software, sensors, and beacon technologies.
- Developed low-level C++ software for microcontrollers and IoT devices, enabling real-time sensor communication.
- Collaborated within an agile software engineering team on testing, quality assurance, and system validation using automated testing frameworks.

Product Manager Intern, Tiktok, Bytedance, Beijing, China

May 2018 to Aug 2018

- Conducted product analysis, competitor benchmarking, and feature evaluation to support digital product strategy.
- Translated user needs and market insights into product requirements.

Awards

Finalist, Digital Economy Award Switzerland – NextGen Hero (2024)

Selected among Switzerland's most promising young digital talents for contributions to digital innovation. Presented research to an audience of over 1,000 participants at Hallenstadion Zürich.

“NextGen Hero” candidates are personalities between the ages of 20 and 28 who have the extraordinary potential to help shape the digital future of Switzerland. The candidates are nominated by Swiss educational institutions.

Languages

German C2, English C2, Chinese (Native)

Areas of Skills

Programming Languages

- Python, C#, C++, Java, JavaScript

Frameworks & APIs

- Unity, Meta Quest SDK, Photon Networking, OpenAI API, Azure Speech Services, LangChain

Embedded & Physical Computing

- Arduino, Raspberry Pi, IoT Sensors

Research Methods

- Qualitative interviews (expert and end users)
- Focus groups
- Co-design workshops
- Usability testing
- Think-aloud studies
- Diary studies
- Autoethnography
- Field studies
- Survey design

Research Tools

- Qualtrics
- Figma
- Miro

References

Prof. Dr. Johannes Schöning, University of St. Gallen

johannes.schoening@unisg.ch